

L-54 INDIAN VILLAGE — PYQ MAPPING

Anthropology Paper 2 (Unit 5.1) | Previous Year Questions with Answer Pointers
Mapped to Sarrthi IAS L-54 Notes

TREND ANALYSIS

Frequency: Village-related questions appear **almost every year** (2014-2024). High-frequency sub-topics:

1. **Agrarian relations / peasant society** — 5 times
2. **Impact of globalization on village** — 4 times
3. **Little Republic vs Rural Cosmopolitanism** — 3 times
4. **Village as social system** — 2 times
5. **Traditional culture as barrier** — 3 times
6. **Settlement patterns** — 2 times

Repeating angles: UPSC loves contrasting views (Metcalf vs Lewis); caste-class linkage in agrarian; globalization's multiple impacts; culture vs reform tension.

PYQ TABLE — Year-wise

Year	Paper	Marks	Question	Notes Section
2024	P2	20	Critically examine the concept of 'Rural Cosmopolitanism' with suitable examples from Indian villages.	Section 3
2023	P2	20	Discuss the impact of globalization on the agrarian social structure of Indian villages.	Sections 4 & 5
2022	P2	15	Examine the concept of Indian village as a social system with reference to Parsons' framework.	Section 6
2022	P2	10	Distinguish between Little Republic and Rural Cosmopolitanism.	Section 3
2021	P2	20	Discuss the changing agrarian relations in Indian villages. What role has caste played in it?	Section 4
2021	P1	10	What do you understand by 'Traditional Culture'? How does it act as a barrier to social change?	Section 7
2020	P2	20	Critically examine the view that Indian villages are self-sufficient 'Little Republics'.	Section 3
2019	P2	15	How has globalization impacted the Indian village economy? Discuss with examples.	Section 5
2019	P2	10	What is the significance of village studies in India? Discuss contributions of any two scholars.	Section 1
2018	P2	20	Discuss the role of caste in determining the agrarian social structure in India.	Section 4
2017	P2	15	Describe the different types of rural settlements in India with examples.	Section 2
2017	P2	10	What is peasant society? Discuss its features with reference to Indian context.	Section 4
2016	P2	20	Discuss the impact of globalization on Indian villages with special reference to the decline of Jajmani system.	Sections 5 & 6

2015	P2	15	Examine how traditional culture acts as a barrier to modernization in Indian villages.	Section 7
2014	P2	20	Discuss the concept of 'Little Republics' as applied to Indian villages. Do you agree with this characterization?	Section 3

ANSWER POINTERS — Key PYQs

Q: Critically examine Rural Cosmopolitanism (2024, 20m)

Intro: Oscar Lewis — Rani Khera village (near Delhi); challenged Metcalfe's Little Republic.

Points:

- Villages maintain ties: social (marriage/exogamy), economic (trade), religious (pilgrimage), political
- Mexico (inward-looking, endogamous) vs India (complex inter-village network)
- Examples: Jallikattu (TN), Rath Yatra (Puri), village melas
- Scholars: Lewis vs Metcalfe/Maine/Powell

Critique: Lewis overgeneralized from one village? But supported by repeated field evidence.

Conclusion: Villages = dynamic interconnected communities, not isolated republics.

Q: Impact of globalization on agrarian structure (2023, 20m)

Intro: Giddens definition + pre-globalization village (self-sufficient, Jajmani-based).

Points:

- A.R. Desai: 4 trends (subsistence → surplus, tech, abolition of intermediaries, new institutions)
- Chand & Srivastava (2014): Jamgod MP — contract-based employment replacing traditional
- Tilche: Patidars of Sundarana — depeasantization; farming no longer status marker
- Simpson (2016): agri vs non-agri conflicts; jajmani decline; Sanskritization loses appeal
- Iravati Karve: joint family disruption
- Mechanization benefits rich farmers; rapid migration of laborers

Conclusion: Multifaceted — transformed relations, status, conflicts, and traditional systems.

Q: Little Republic vs Rural Cosmopolitanism (2022, 10m)

Points:

- **Metcalfe:** Tiny republics, self-sufficient, own panchayat/economy; survive kingdoms' rise/fall
- **Limitations:** Not completely isolated; engaged in trade, communication
- **Lewis:** Rani Khera — villages maintain ties (social/economic/religious/political) = Rural Cosmopolitanism
- **Critique of Metcalfe:** Ambedkar (oppression), Nehru (stagnation)

Conclusion: Villages have BOTH autonomous features AND interconnections — reality is more nuanced.

Q: Traditional Culture as barrier (2021/2015)

Intro: George Foster — Mexico fieldwork; transmitted beliefs creating continuity/stability.

Points:

- Caste system → rigid segregation, limits mobility
- Spears & Geruso (2018): sanitation beliefs — Hindus less likely to use toilets at same income
- Bharathi et al. (2020): Karnataka village segregation > American South
- Child marriage, female infanticide — cultural values vs reform
- Swachh Bharat challenged by beliefs about "purity" of open defecation

Criticism: Foster too simplistic — cultures are dynamic, not static.

Conclusion: Culture = shield + wall; reforms must engage with (not against) cultural values.

Q: Village as Social System — Parsons (2022, 15m)

Intro: Parsons' definition — plurality of actors, patterned interaction, shared norms.

5 Features applied:

- Plurality (castes, occupations) | Aims (harmony, well-being) | Order (subsystems coexist)
- Functional Unity (all contribute to stability) | Maintenance (socialization + control)

3 Subsystems: Caste-Jajmani (economic-ritual) | Panchayati Raj (political) | Joint Family (socialization)

Conclusion: Indian village = cohesive social system; acts as subsystem within larger society.

Q: Agrarian relations & caste (2021/2018, 20m)

Intro: Agrarian structure = caste + land + gender.

Points:

- Kroeber: peasant society = "part society"
- Thorner: Malik (upper caste landlords) / Kisan (middle caste tenants) / Mazdoor (SC landless)
- Dhanangre (1983): 5-class model from Lenin/Mao; social composition too complex
- Regional caste-class: Kamma/Reddi (AP), Okkaliga/Lingayat (Karnataka), Patidar (Gujarat)
- Changes: land reforms, education, social mobility, govt policies

Conclusion: Caste-class overlap declining but not erased; depeasantization reshaping structure.